

Actor

Turn on the light. (The lights immediately flip on.) I am not here. I am not talking. I am not talking to you. I am not looking at you. You are not with me. I don't know where I am but this is not me. This is someone else. None of this is happening to me. I am not in this. You can't see me. So what does this body look like? What color is there skin? Who's attracted to you? Who are you attracted to? Is this body short, tall? Do you like yourself? What color are their eyes? Does it bother you to see yourself in the mirror? Can we get some more light on the actor? (A spotlight is provided.) Turn very slowly. Now I want you to answer. How old are you. (The actor answers.) What is your favorite season? (Answer.) Are your parents together? (Answer.) Do you have any siblings? (Answer.) Are you in love with someone? (Answer.) Are you nervous? (Answer.) Tense your body. You can relax your body after I count to three. One, two. (Silence.) Three. How is your stomach? You should have a pack of cigarettes. Smoke two of them. By now you should be getting a gun from somewhere. (In sequence with the lines.) The actor pulls out a gun. Tells the audience that she or he will be pointing the gun at them. I'm going to point the gun at you. Nobody fuckin move. Yell at the audience again. I said shut the fuck up. Make an example.

(The Actor grabs Fake.)

Fake

No

Actor

Try again. I couldn't hear you.

Fake

No.

Actor

No ones buying it. Least of all...

Fake

Just wait a God dammed minute.

Actor

Least of all me. Any last words. (The Actor shoots Fake.) Not everyone gets to speak. (The actor shoots fake. Fake does not move.) Is he dead? If he is not dead why isn't he moving and what would it take to get him to move. Do you smell something burning? (The actor points at the "dead" body) That is an example. Moving right along. Go to the center of the stage. Put out your arm. (There should be 2 hands showing one of a gun and the other open.) Ask them to help you. Help me. You can relax now. (The actor does.) You're showing wonderful control. Now get on your knees next to the body. You should feel bad about this. Say you're sorry. I'm sorry. Ask them to move. Please move. (Fake does not move.) Do you think you can cry? Say I'm sorry. I'm sorry. Again, I'm sorry. I'm sorry. Again, I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. (The actor continues until they feel to stop.) I hope you are crying now. Wonderful control. You can relax. I'll give you some protection. (Mother and father shuffle on sideways. They are pressed between wood that is cut out to represent clothing.) Are you comfortable?

Father

Oh my God.

Mother

What.

Father

(He says the number of people that are in the audience.) People were taken hostage by some actor pretending to be someone else. Caught the whole place on fire. Here it, listen to this. After the fire died down. The fire Marshall recovered a script outlining the death of 7 actors and the mass murder of all (The audience number.) audience members. The police are not able to speculate how...when...where...until they have pieced the script together. (Actor rings the bell.)

Father

I God hostage actor fire listen script death (The bell.)
hostage actor fire script death (Ring.) I hostage actor death
(Ring) I actor death (Ring.) I death (Ring.) Death
(Ring.)

Mother

Isn't that weird.

Father

(daughter or son) can I bend your ear? There is no such thing
as percentage.

Actor

Bring in the clowns.

Clown 1

When is an itch not an itch?

Clown 2

I don't know. (Clown 1 laughs.)

Clown 1

What is the difference between dying and being deceased?

Clown 2

I don't know.

Clown 1

What is the similarity between asking and not knowing?

Clown 2

I don't know.

Clown 1

Come on.

Clown 2

I don't know.

Clown 1

Shit man.

Clown 2

I really don't know.

Clown 1

Okay, Transition. (They pull out hand held mirrors and Place them Over Their Faces.)

1 & 2

Nobody Fuckin Move. I'm Sorry.

Clown 2

Hey one moment what do you see.

Clown 1

The back of this mirror

Clown 2

Why what do you see.

Clown 1

The same.

Clown 2

Okay.

1 & 2

How much money do you have none because I have some you wouldn't by chance have the time it's approximately (1 and 2 Guess what time it is, to the mint.) It's good that we think the same. I wonder if from a distance we appear to be thinking together. (They start moving their hands together.) Maybe if we moved our arm at the same time it would. Well it depends on what you mean by together. The line becomes very thin. Do you smell something burning or is that just me. I'm waiting for the bus. If this was real life I might be able to reviews. Is their fake life? (10 seconds silence. The clowns lower their mirrors.)

Clown 2

Jesus Christ what the hell just happened.

Clown 1
I don't know.

Clown 2
I thought we were doing the mirrors bit.

Clown 1
We both have mirrors. (Silence.)

Clown 2
See there you go again.

Clown 1
What?

Clown 2
This whole system

Clown 1
Who.

Clown 2
Fuck you.

Clown 1
Hey fuck you.

Clown 2
You're the one with the epiphany. Why don't I have one of those?

Clown 1
Come on let's share a popular soft drink.

Clown 2
No.

Clown 1
Let's have sex.

Clown 2
What? (Looks off slightly.)

Clown 1
I could kill you. I want resolve. Anyway if you were a real

actor, you would stay in the moment.

Clown 2

I don't know what to say.

Clown 1

Liar. (Clown one pulls out a gun. Clown 2 begins to run.

The set can leave now. (The set goes. After the set is gone Clown 1 shoots clown 2. Clown 1 Kneels next to the body and whispers.) You're really not dead. Cheer up. (A cardboard bus is wheeled on by a three-wheeled bicycle. All of the cardboard people have signs that read "I am not real." And painted on the side of the bus in a sloppy fashion "I am not a real bus.") Here it comes. Wrong bus. (The bus goes by.) Taxi. (A cardboard taxi follows after the bus. With a sign reading real taxi. The clown 1 Rides in a couple of circles and exits. The lights go out and come up slowly on an ice cream bakery with tables, chairs and a long counter facing the audience. Two young men stand at each middle end of the counter with a rag in their hands. A homeless man sits asleep at a point furthest from the entrance.)

Hostage

Hey John what time is it...what time do we close? (John comes on with a tub of ice cream.)

Hostage

I don't know. Eleven maybe. Maybe earlier, depending on the customers.

Hostage

It's pretty dead.

Hostage

I don't know.

Hostage

It could pick up. The movie isn't out.

Hostage

People haven't finished their dinner. (The Hostages come in.)

Hostage
What would you like?

Hostage
Rum raisin.

Hostage
Cup or cone.

Hostage
Cup, no, cone, no cup.

Hostage
Anything else.

Hostage
Cone.

Hostage
Is there a particular flavor that you were wanting or.

Hostage
Well, what flavors do you have?

Hostage
There is a sign right behind me. Right there. We have lots of...

Hostage
Ok, ok.

(Clown rushes in and shoots the nearest Hostage to the door.
People scream.)

Clown 1
WOooo. Yeah. Yeah. WOoo. Fuck me. WOoo. It's so good. Yeah.
Let it happen. (Calmly.) Everybody shut the fuck up.
Everybody get out their wallets, pull out your money. Are you
listening? Pull out all of your money. Silence. (Silence.)
Does everyone have their money out, whole it up in front of your
face. If anyone, anyone hesitate. (The clown shoots a

homeless man that is across the stage from the clown.) That might have seemed a little reactionary. What can I say I'm not even a clown? (Clown keeps gun pointed on stage.) Start tearing the money. Tear the money. Did you like that I said it twice?

Hostage

Look, please, I've got children, I mean babies, babies.

Clown 1

Can I get real close to you?

Hostage

1 month, and three...

Clown 1

Don't you wonder about all those 0's, clown starts to get closer (the clown does.)? The possibility of us meeting here on such a night. You want to hear a joke. "Yes" there's this little boy and he's pushing this little red wagon up this hill and he's pushing and pushing and pushing and pushing. Then he starts with all of his frustration, screaming god dam it, Jesus fuckin Christ. Mother fucker, fuckin, fuck, fuck, fuck, A preacher on the side of the road musing on the kids struggles, I'm the preacher now. He comes running over and says, whoa, whoa, whoa. Young man don't talk like that don't you know that Jesus is everywhere. The kid looks up at him. So Jesus is everywhere. That's right Jesus is everywhere. The kid you know is a real smart-ass. And says Jesus is everywhere. That's right Jesus is everywhere. Is Jesus in that little White House over there? Yes Jesus is everywhere. Is Jesus in that little blue house over there? Yes Jesus is everywhere. Is Jesus in that little green house over there? Yes. Yes Jesus is everywhere. Is Jesus in my little red wagon? Yes Jesus is everywhere. Well tell him to get the fuck out and help push. (Pause.) Everything can be vaguely connected that's pretty specific. Isn't it and the camera moves away. So does the clown. (The clown moves away.) I know what you're not going to say. Your not going to say a clown is cliché. You're not going to say that are you. (Talks behind his hand.) "No. Yes. Some one help me. I don't want to die." I didn't tell you to talk. "Help, help." Shut up. ? BANG, BANG. I'm sorry. " I've been shot. Everything. Everyone is no no long... Mom I'm so

cold." I'm sorry. "Mom, shit I can't feel my arms. Everything is no, no, no." No. No. No. That would be unrealistic. It's like when two cats. You know. Sit in a room. You know. The same way. You know. Same distance. You know. Pick your square in the kitchen. You're looking at the lime at the bottom of the glass. Where does the liquid go? You know if all of you came at me. Only one maybe two or hell 3 would get shot. Now the chances of the shot being fatal only the government knows. If you waited, for just the right moment. Now choosing that moment. Depending on character flaws, half-empty, half full. What am I saying? You're not going to do anything. It's in the stars. So I can keep your attention. I'll kill one of you. (Hostage runs at clown 1.)

Hostage

Get him. (No one moves. Customer stops short of the Clowns Gun.) Fuck. (Clown shoots him.)

Clown 1

Do I have your attention? Do I. Do I. (Pause.) Okay pretend that he's not pretending to be dead. So for practical purposes. He's alive. O..ooo..what, why, please, why me. Don't shoot me. SSsshhh. And to make you feel better I'll talk to the thou. Hey guys should I shoot him in the face or the chest. The chest. It's easier on stage. Depending on budget. Just think the way you die is dependent on budget. (The clown shoots him.) Do I have your attention? Do I. Do I.

(Actor comes in from behind the audience with a bullhorn and says the name of the actor that is playing the clown.)

Actor

This is the... (Says the name of the state that the play is) Being performed in.) State police. I need you to talk to me. Maybe you need something. Is there something you need to tell us? Just pick up the phone.

Clown 1

I want. Clown pulls out a list of things that they themselves prepared for this moment. (Clown reads.) From there I want to be flown to the Galapagos Islands. That's all. (Clown hangs up the phone.) SSShhhhhhhh.

Actor

I need everything, everything I can get on this guy where, when, what, how. I mean everything. Who are his mom and dad? I need in there. Family friends, neighbors, acquaintances, if they know the piece of shit. We know the piece of shit.

Clown 1

DUN DUN what will happen to the hostages. DUN DUN Will they all pretend to die. DUN DUN Who is this clown. DUN DUN Is this the end of act 1. Let's see. (Pause.) I won't kill for 14 pages. This will give you a chance to plead, beg, and I'm sure to come up with synonym to save your character. This will give us interesting text while we wait for the end of the play. Where I will kill all of you. But it will buy you some time. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. Now everyone. You never know. You, look bitch start talking or this will be the shortest 14 pages you ever acted. Your lucky that it would be inappropriate to stick this gun in your ass. Start talking. Now everybody.

All

You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know. You never know.

Clown 1

Why are you saying this?

Hostage

Because you told me to.

Clown 1

That's right. I'm going to like you. Really, I can feel that. You have something. I don't know. Something special. Something, something, I don't know. Something beautiful. How old are you. No, no, don't tell me. Twenty-nine, No. Fifteen, that's it. Seventy-one, that's it. That's it. Wow, I really didn't, I mean, it was really just a guess. I didn't know how good I was until I, well. Until I met (Pause.) you. It's like I never existed until (Pause.) you. Maybe if you get a chance we could go out on, and you. I don't know how you feel about

that. But I'm in love with you. I love you. I can't help it. I love you. I want, I want, god, I don't know how to say it. I just want. Jesus Christ. I'm just going to say it. I see us. Okay. I see us in the woods. Far away from everybody. No. We're the last people on earth and we're naked and you're standing on the roots of this mystical tree. Your skin is so unmistakable against the clouds, the bark of the tree and all I can do, want to do is look at you. I'm sitting on one of the lower roots, you know, kind of, with my legs pull against me trying to fight the chill of the morning but I can feel myself throb. I can't help it. I'll hate to move. I hate those few feet that will occupy my body to get to you. I'll be moving before I even acknowledged I was hesitating. I would have wanted to stick my face into the hair around your privates. Before that, before I could. I would be against you trying not to bite you too hard. Trying to become you. Even how good it would be. To be next to you. I would want to give you everything. I don't know. I can't help it. I'd just want you to come in my mouth. I'm sorry. I'd want you to tell me that you loved me while I did it. Touching my cheeks. Touch my lips, my head with both of your hands spread out across my head. There wouldn't be any words we couldn't say. There wouldn't be any words we'd have to say. Nothing we couldn't do. (Silence.) Too bad we're in a room full of dead bodies. Jump up and down. (Pause. The hostage begins jumping.) Stop. I don't feel much like a customer. Turn the music off. If you don't come back you'll be a coward. I just might kill a woman. You never know. (Server runs off. The music is turned off. Server comes back soon after.)

Hostage

You planned to catch fire to yourself...at...

Clown 1

Hey have you ever had to pray on stage. This will make for a nice publicity shot. Get on your knees. I'm going to point the gun at you. Just relax and pray. (Pause.) Okay I'll help you. (Swiftly steps and places the barrel of the gun against the server's head.) Wake the fuck up.

Hostage

Shit.

Clown 1

That's enough. So. Does God ignore you? Seeing that you are in a play. See I've proven that there's a God. God ignores you because you are in a play. Because he loves you so much that he forgives you for being in a play. Let's see, damn. What do they? That good things come to those. No. Yes. Everything happens for a reason. Homeless people die. You know they deserve what they get. Let go of the human body. It's expendable. The soul. The spirit. Catch yourself on fire. Passive activism. It's okay. Because I have faith. That God dam alcohol. That God dam heroin. That God dam television set. My God dam lover is a dickhead. Now you're blowing it out of proportion. They're just working through some problems. Dam synonyms. God semantics. Dam conjecture. Why don't you look at the audience? Because this is bigger than all of them. It's you and I. It's so vague it... you know, you can't prove to me that any of this is here. By the way that was almost half a page. (Pause.) This would be a good time. (Laughs.) This would be a good time for you to speak. Do you think? Do you think that the dickhead was gender biased? Come on. Are you just going to let me talk? Just sit on your knees and let the script go by. Could you just continue pretending that you don't know where this is going?

Actor

(The first name of the actor that is playing the clown.)
Your mother, if it's okay would like to talk to you.

Clown 1

Pitch black. Sure that would be great. (Picks up the phone.) Hi. Oh sure. Oh I don't know. I just felt like murdering a bunch. (Pause.) You know. Kill, kill, kill. Oh I don't know. And what about the dad. No. That's... It's really a good part. Hey. Hey. Wat a minute. I just couldn't help. No. That's not true. Well. (Pause.) I know. (Pause.) Well I'm sorry. No, mommy. You... No, mommy. No. No. I'm sorry. I'm sorry. This isn't what I wwawa... you just wouldn't. I know I say that all the time. If you would have just... I know you love me. Start over. It's too late. I...you never know. No one can help me. (Pause.) They don't. They don't. I don't want to be this. Not this way. You think so. You think so. You think so. Think so. Think so. Think so. (Lets the phone drop, dangling at his side.) Think so. (Pause.) No one is actually there. (Pause.) There is no character named

mommy. Shoebox planet. Turtles on top of turtles holding up this pearl of a planet. Some kid is in a shoebox making a universe in a shoebox. Where are my manners? I'm insensible, crazy. Don't mind me. Nothing sensible from me. From here on out crazy. So where were we question mark? You are on your knees period. What do you think of massacre at the ice cream shop? It's got that tell the whole play kind of feeling. What about this? (Pause.) I know it's got that kind of connected is the same as unconnected 'j'ne sais quoi.' Or that going give us a nod every time it's said. Yeah, oh yeah (brackets there hand around the words.) Even if it was murder. Bang, bang, bang!!!

Hostage

What are you talking about? You're here. This is an ice cream shop.

Clown 1

Wrong buddy there's baked goods all over this place that makes it a bakery/ice cream shop. Slash. Where the hell do you think you are? (Pause.) What? You, you, you mean this is all going on in my head. No one can see me. There's no one to look at. Even better.

Hostage

I want to live.

Clown 1

Pitch black.

Hostage

What do you want me to say? Will you let us go?

Clown 1

To the floor.

Hostage

Why? (Pause.) Please don't shoot. Why are you angry? Is it something we did?

Clown 1

Who said I was angry? That's really my choice isn't it?

Hostage

I can't change this?

Clown 1

You never know. Everyone will be on my side. You will not only do what I say you will do it when I say. If I asked you to shit in one hand and dream in the other then you will. Every. (Pause.) One. (Pause.) Every. (Silence.) One. (Silence.) Every. (Pause. Silence. The clown holds up one finger.) One.

Actor

So we can't get a clear shot. That's what you're saying.

Clown 2

We're not sure about the tunnels under town.

Actor

My God.

Clown 2

The building is too old.

Actor

As soon as you know.

Clown 2

You'll know.

Actor

Calm down. If (She or he.) would calm down. I shouldn't have brought the mother. She said they get along. I'm fucked. What was I supposed to do. One day this (Girl or guy.) Fucks it all up. (Silence.) This is all new to me. I just wanted to defuse the situation. Do we have a make on the people?

Clown 2

Not yet.

Actor

Who's this killer?

Clown 2

Roll up on a tricycle.

Actor

I'm a real taxi. What fuck do we do with that?

Clown 2

Crazy. That's all. Fuckin crazy.

Actor

(Talks in a walkie-talkie.) Is the FBI here yet? (The actor hands the bullhorn to the policeman and they sit down.)

Clown 1

Everyone take off your clothes. Only to your underwear. No genitalia. From here on out, no such thing as genitalia. (The clown 1 kicks a clown costume out of a back.) Pick up. Put on. The pants. The shoes. The wig. The coat. (The hostage hesitates.) The nose. The nose. You act like we've never done this before. Now you're in costume. Move closer (shoots hostage in the foot.) Together. Together. Move. Move. Go, go. Shut up shut up. (Pause). Elevator breaks down between floors. Everybody put down your hands. Shut up. Shut up. (Shoots the gun in the air.) That wasn't supposed to get you to calm down. Put down your hands. You are on an elevator it breaks down between floors. Go. Talk about your problems you need to get to work. (To the hostage that was shot in the foot.) It's okay. For you. This is okay. Okay. I know you are just pretending. So you're okay. You guys are old. You love each other. (Points to the last hostage.) Money and you'er smart.

Hostage

I'm okay. I'm okay. I'm okay. I'm okay.

Clown 1

You're in love. Hold hands.

Hostage

I'm okay. I okay.

Hostage

Money?

(Simultaneous talking.)

Hostage

Okay, okay, okay, okay, okay, okay, okay, okay, okay, okay...

Hostage

I need money. I'd need money. I (pause.) I...

Clown 1

Work. Work.

Hostage

Work. Work.

Clown 1

The old woman she's having a baby. The old woman. (Points at the hostage who is designated as old woman.) She's having a baby. Look... (Points the gun at 1 hostage.) Help her. Dad, dad, this is a total surprise. Come on. Surprised. You call this a birth. God damn it. Get on the mother fuckin floor. (Dad sits down immediately.) With the mother. Help the old bitch to the floor. She's carrying your future. Oh this is beautiful you're Mary, you're Joe. You smell something burning. Oh my God. The frankincense is on fire. Flashing lights. Okay the elevator is getting to smoky to breathe. She's pregnant. Nobody wants to die. Pull yourselves together. Oh my God the baby. You can see the head. Someone is knocking. You hear it. It might not die. Help. Help. The baby. Help. The door. Open. Clean air. Thank God for vehicle omissions. The baby was still born. Wow you guys. That was beautiful. It's so good that we can work together. Just calm down. That was great guys. Everyone lay down. You're okay. I'm sorry. I'll give you some time to just relax. Breathe it in. I need you to let it go. You're really not in danger. (The hostages look down at the hostage that has been shot in the foot.) It's okay to laugh. But I really need you to think about the stillborn child. Okay everyone lay down. I'm going to lay down with you. It's okay. I swear it's okay. Lay down. Lay down. Will get

up after I count to three. One. (Everyone lies down. The clown keeps the gun pointed at them. The lights go down. Spotlight on Dennis the homeless man that was shot. He is standing. Lights out. Lights up. Dennis gears up with Jym bags filled with hand held instruments and a 70-lb. pack. Dennis walks to the door as if actor was leaving. Lights out as Dennis reaches the door. Lights up. Dennis is pointed the opposite way and walking in. Dennis reaches the furthest point from the door. Lights out. Lights up.)

Dennis

Jab. Jab, jab, jab, jab. (Dennis turns to the counter.) I love this coffee. This is the stuff. (Freeze. Pause. Lights out. Lights up. Dennis is sitting at the front window bar reading. Bags are sitting next to him. Ten seconds. Lights out. Lights up. Dennis has turned from the reading.) Why would you want that? Take your time. (Lights out. Lights up.) And he had lost his mother. Hey Lee did I tell you that I went to the Park. Yeah, because I knew when those guys took off. Something wasn't right. (Pause.) They took my name. They made me look dishonest. So I went down to the Park. You see it wasn't the guy I usually do business with. It was some friends of his. Brother. (Pause.) Well I had to. I felt bad. They were all lying down. They were all lying down. It wasn't you. It was me. They saw me coming. I could see that he was puffing up. (Lights down. Lights up. Dennis is with his back to the audience.) They were agitated seeing me coming. You screwed me and a friend. (Dennis raises his hands.) I'm not guilty. Freezing. My fingers. And it was closed. And he swung at me. And I wanted to be a big shot. So I spent all that money. Going on Cruces. I didn't know any better. I finally got myself out of bed. It was so cold that I didn't even do my stretches. I was just looking for shelter. Gather. Get to the Salvation Army. Out the front door, closed. Wouldn't let anyone in. I was mad. I'm standing next to the river. Snow. (Freeze.) I'm not guilty. Yell it. I'm not guilty. Guilty. And that was the first time I believed it. (Lights out. Lights up. Dennis is on the other side with his bags walking out. Lights out. Lights up. Dennis has his backpack on.) My back pack. Hit me. 70 pounds. My back, it laid him out. His face and he had lost his mother. Like he had lost his mother. It was like I was hitting a dead body. I said no witch none of that sorcery, not today. I said. She called me to tell me that

I should. Russia. Come over. Come on. But to me it was the most unusual music. Nothing unusual to someone that had lived there. It was. She wouldn't have sex with me. Not because it was wrong, not like here. People were more generous because well it's like when you hum with the vacuum. It was just elevator music to them. But to me it was the most comforting. (Dennis goes to the door as if he was leaving. Lights out. Lights up. Dennis is coming in with bags.) Shit man. Is that so. No shit. John do you think you could set me up with a day old. How's Unu. That's fucked up. That was my piece of cake. If you guys want to act like children you can take it outside. What's going on. (Dennis begins to leave. Lights out. Lights up.) Grandmother, go out and get the dirt. Clean it. Her. Noni, Noni. It's not to far from here. Watch her. (Lights out. Lights up.) It's not to far. (Lights out. Lights up.) Jab, jab, jab, jab. He gets a call. Come over. Smell. Heart attack. Over radiator. Jab, jab, jab. Why would you want to do that? Take your time. Didn't get this scar for nothing. Like humming with the elevator. Why haven't I seen any angels? Why haven't I seen angels? My face is on the floor. (Lights out. Lights up. Dennis is back in place.)

Clown 1

Three. I'm looking so forward to killing everyone. I wish everyone could do this. Okay, you're in the desert. Your bus has broken down. It's been one night since your...since you've talked. Your stranded. Take it easy. The sun is giving the nearby mountains a massage. The heat begins steaming your eyes open. I want you guys to stand up, stand up, and just look around, survey the area. Stand. Is the land rocky and flat? (Pause.) While you are looking around you see a rock, a pebble. Pick it up. While your holding the rock. You discover that you are a horrible person. Let that sink in. (Pause.) You are a horrible person. (Pause.) You notice that everyone has something in their hand. Put your rock in your pocket. (The hostages look at their hands.) What about water? How long has it been? Are you thirsty? (The hostages are hardly doing anything.) I'm doing this because I love you. It's all because of love. I love to yell at cars. The people in the cars. Here I am. (Mimes driving and waving.) Fuck you. Look you fuckin piece of shit. Look at me. I love to kill. It's true. You didn't pay attention to your family. You really didn't care. You never shit. Do you turn on the water? Hold it in. They've

almost, are they gone. I am so fat. Who am I? Wait a minute. Some people don't have this problem. Then you remember a story of sand monkeys. On one of those shows. Get some melon seeds. Put them in to a hole in a tree. Make sure there's a sand monkey around. I'm not sure if seeds are necessary. Anything will do. Sand monkeys are curious. They see your hiding something. They've got to know what it is. They grab it and they get stuck. Feed them garlic. You remember the road. The hole. You remember the monkey's lips on the garlic. What is the size of your mouth? (Clown 1 points gun at the closest hostage. Pause.)

Hostage

What...what. (Pause.)

Clown 1

We're pausing for the police conversations. How big is your mouth. Without using your hands, I want you, after I say now. Feel in your mouth. Now. Wait. Without using your tongue. Now. Stop using your. No mouth. Look don't use your. No movement. Just sit there. Now. Feel the darkness. Now, how big is your mouth. How does the audience feel? You guys are so selfish. Only thinking of yourselves. That audience member, being. So far. I had a choice but now I'm so angry. (Shoots a hostage.)

Hostage

Oh, my God. Why did you do that?

Clown 1

The auditions. They said now was what Theater was.

Hostage

What are you? This is not a movie. (Pause.) This is not a movie. I can see it in your face. You know what I am saying. It's true.

Clown 1

I...

Hostage

We're only people. There's a difference.

Clown 1
They're pretending.

Hostage
You killed them.

Clown 1
That's not true.

Hostage
These people are all dead.

Clown 1
This has happened before. Look. I said you guys were selfish. Then I... (Clown shoots the same hostage that had been shot before.) See. I feel so cheated. We've done this so many times. I'm. I have said this and I have spoken this and I have verbalized on this. The play could be named this.

Hostage
This is real.

Clown 1
That is what I'm saying. Exactly. I'm rambling on because I wanted a job in my field. I have to. I'm killing you because I needed something to do. Who's got the water? How long have you been here? I bet you're really thirsty. How thirsty are you.

Hostage
You killed my husband. You killed my husband.

Clown 1
He's resting.

Hostage/clown 1
You killed my husband. You...son of a bitch. Oh my God.

Clown 1
I love singing.

Clown 1
It's okay you were simply better. Did you see? Couldn't work

the crowd. Don't blame yourself for being good. Pause. Why do you think I was talking? They are all against you. Please. Come on. Money shot. Look I'm strong. Wake up. No, no you're right. Tell me if I've told this one to you. Tell me. (Pause.) Why don't we have? Oh, wait. Why. Okay. Why. Tell me if you have. If I have told this one before, to you, I'm sorry, wait. Forget it, okay. (Laughs. Pause.) You know what's funny you never laugh. At that one. You get it? Why don't we have three sleeves? Because we only have two arms. So I guess I am out to get you. Half empty, half full or half. Start frowning. Start smiling. Start. Stop. It's the God dammed traffic light. Lights help. Honk, honk. (Clown waves.) Kids are playing leapfrog (10 second silence.) Kids are playing leapfrog. How many times did I say that? (Pause.) I would say with all inflections once. It's hostages that hold this together. Applaud. (The hostages do.) Let's hear it for hostages. (Clown writes hostage in the air with his finger rolls it up in a ball.) Now catch. Pick it up. (Starts to pick it up.) Slowly, that's... like you don't know what I mean. Right. Hold it. We can see you see it. You're alone with it. I'm not going to fuck with you. Someone going to die with the ball in their hands. It's all right. To your friends.

Hostage

I don't know.

Clown 1

You're too modest. Throw the ball.

Hostage

Where do...

Clown 1

Who.

Hostage

Who... do I?

Clown 1

Anyone.

Hostage

I can't.

Clown 1

How did I know you would say that? (Gun whips the hostage. There is blood.) Yeah, this is fun. I don't know why I did that. I bet you don't. Muy Eridge invented the basis of the motion picture, to see if the horse had a foot on the ground, in 1872. So you pick it up and you throw it. The space between the horse and the ground. I'll help you up (clown does nothing. Hostage stands slowly with one hand holding their head and holding a imaginary ball.) The ball, that's it. Throoo... (Hostage throws the imaginary ball.) Good. You let it just hit you. Guess what. Down, down. (Hostage bends slowly looking for reference to the ball by the clown.) There it is. When you throw it you catch it. Go ahead. I'll tell you when to stop. (The ball freezes in the air. When Dennis speaks he does not move.)

Dennis

Forgive me for I, I, I...shit, great spirit....Out... (Dennis passes out.)

Actor

So is the mother going to keep it quiet?

Clown 2

She's pretty devastated. I don't think that she'll talk.

Actor

Good. I can't let this psycho take it all. What about the father.

Clown 2

Don't know.

Actor

Tell me when he gets here.

Clown 2

Okay.

Actor

I'm going to lose my job.

Clown 2

No you...

Actor
I will.

Clown 2
We won't let that happen.

Actor
Is the FBI here?

Clown 2
It's their show now. (Clown 2 sits. Clown 2 changes his/her hat and stands.)

Actor
They're here.

Clown 2
You're relieved. Low down. (Actor sits and stands with a FBI cap.)

Actor
It's bad as soon, as soon, as we find out what...

Clown 2/ Actor
Happened.

Clown 2
Will tell, will tell me. Great.

Actor
How the hell did this fucking person get a gun?

Clown 2
Do you know what the two conversations not to have in a situation are?

Actor
What.

Clown 2
Religion and politics. One because if some person around hears. They find and you may find that it can be difficult to

speak on such things when you have to tell the family or co-worker that they are dead. Two you and I are carrying guns. And we will leave it at that. One on stage and three trampled from panic. Even if it was murder. Do we have a script?

Actor

Almost.

Clown 2

We need to keep calling. Talk as much as possible. How many groups are in the tunnel?

Actor

Two.

Clown 2

If not, through the front and back. Call.

Dennis

I'm awake. I'm awake. I'm bleeding. (The phone rings and ball begins to move.)

Clown 1

Keep the ball going. (Clown 1 picks up the phone.)

If it was real life the cops would be in here so quick. In real life policeman don't have a very high divorce rate. They have no alcoholism. No inferiority complex. Disease fighters. You better call the bomb squad you symptom fucker. (Hangs up the phone.) Okay everybody line up. You, you, you, into the bathroom. Go, go, go, go, (the hostages shuffle in.) Okay, great. Could you grab the wig? (Pause. Picks it off the body and throws it to the hostage.) Gross. Put it on your head. You're an out of work clown, you see in the paper that a big top was looking for a clown. Now you come in to the big top and there it is you see it and I'm the boss. Let's see it. (This is improvisational.) Stop. YAK, yak, yak. (They do this for a 1/4 of a page.) Tell the next one to come on. Decide amongst yourselves. Sit down. (Hostage sits.) Next. (Pause.) The pattern. Guys, next. (The next hostage comes on stage.) Wait a minute. I need everyone to listen. Garbage bags are perforations on a player piano ribbon. I bet the weight...excruciating, excruciating. We're going to have fun. Who was going next? We're going to have some...Sorry have to

keep the pressure going. That's your hostage. (Points at the hostage that is sitting.) You want. You want, them convinced that they'er in a play. Try things like Holistic to specific, play in a play, in play, just suggestions. For sure in a play, in a play and when I say, you shoot them with your finger. You just sit there. (Improv) Blah, blah, blah, blah, blah... Next. (Next hostage.) Sit down. You are a porn star. You like having sex. Sex is on your mind. You curse all the time. You are about to curse now. But, but you don't. Later. You have a shoot later. Where you'll do things naked with other people. Not now. Later. Right now, bowl of cereal. You're having a bowl of cereal. Go. It's simple. Have a bowl of cereal. Eat. (Hostage mimes a bowl of cereal. Silence.) You know what. (To the hostage.) I'm sorry. But this reminds... tell me if you have heard this one. Why don't we have three arms because we only have two sleeves? Next. Next. Next. (Hostage runs at the clown with a piece of broken bathroom mirror. Clown 1 shoots hostage.) Did you see that? Just nod. (The last remaining hostages do.) Well. (Silence.) Well. (The gender of the actor.) Are not getting out of this. Pick him up. Pick him up. Do I have to be angry to say things twice? (One hostage begins.) Help them. Pick (him/her) up and put (him/her) on your back. Walk in a circle, that way, then back. Do a circle. (Silence. Clown has the hostages do long circles and has them stop at the point that it becomes its own piece.) Put them down. You take their costume. You want to live don't you? Don't give up now.

Clown 2

Why didn't anyone tell me they had a bomb?

Actor

We didn't know. Look this is all new.

Clown 2

You smell like liquor. Get out of here. I can't fuckin believe this shit. What in the fuck. I can't believe this shit. (Actor sits and stands.)

Actor

The president is on the phone.

Clown 2

President is what.

Actor

(Sex) wants to talk to you.

Clown 2

What in the hell is going on?

Actor

I don't know.

Clown 2

We have to break this shit. Keep on it. I'll be back. What am I going to say?

Actor

Here's the phone. (Pause.)

Clown 2

Yes...(Pause.) Excuse me. (Pause.) Yes (Sex). (Hangs up the phone.)

Actor

What.

Clown 2

There's a nuclear warhead next to a day care center in New York City. There was a letter sent earlier this morning to the White House explaining the whereabouts of the bomb. It's a remote. It's in there. The last line in the note read the day the clowns cried. We're suppose to sit tight until further notice. (The phone rings Clown 2 answers the phone.)

Clown 1.

Whoa. (Spotlight on clown 1, who is holding a cell phone.) I'm going to talk to you like I've never talk to you before. I well; I've put nuclear bombs all over the place. Shopping centers. All the churches. All of the schools. The cities. Your living room. Just think. Just think of all those little symptoms. They're all red footprints. Not many people have come this way. Is that a beer can? I can see you. (Hangs up the phone. Lights up on stage.) Gather. Sit, great. Don't quit on me. We have to keep energized. Don't let any of this get you down. We can beat this. So pull, hold, stay, keep...I

believe in you. You know why because, I've seen you do it before. I love you. I love you. I'm not going to make a big thing out of this, but I'm going to... I'm going to kill one of you. We have to continue. We're going to prevent this. You're the one. Keep crying your helping the cause. (Shoots them.) Whoa, whoa, whoa, don't do that. Don't you know Jesus is everywhere? Is Jesus in my little red wagon? (Holds up the cell phone.) Yes, yes he is. (Freeze. Dennis begins to dance around the stage with a tambourine, making circles around the stage.)

Dennis

Great spirit. I here before you. Stand. Love surrounds me. I don't want to stay. Love surrounds me. Love surrounds me. I don't want to be here. Come on. Surround me. Take me. I didn't get this scar for nothing. Great spirit. (Begins to dance around.) I'm ready to go. I'm ready. Take me out. Come on. I'm surrounded by love. (Lights fade to black.) This is my time. I don't want to be here. I'm ready to go.

Clown 1

You need the smell of gasoline lofting through the theater to give a fuck. Okay I'm going to be as frank. The human race is pathetic pieces of shit. This isn't a play. This is really happening. There you go. You stupid piece of shit. You win. This isn't a play. This is all real. The human being is the only animal that shit where they sleep. You and I in a plot to kill everyone. I've had love up to my neck. God be with us on every Nazi belt buckle. (Clown 1 stops. Actor and Clown 2 recite a scripted advertisement from popular culture. Clown 1 starts.) You fuckin moron. Why don't you go to sleep? I want you to never wake up. At least I'm resolved. I'm going to do something. You are going to help me. I want as few people alive as possible. We're going to give the whole world cancer. Where are my people at? (Clown 1 spurts racial and social slurs.) Where are my people at? Frog in water. Put a huge hole in the sky. Definitely would the up ratings. (The name and date the actor that is playing the clown 1 was born.)

Clown 2

Listen up people. The (sex) name is (name). Was born to (names). On (date). (A quick case study and life events.) We have no motive. No reason for any of this. We have a warhead

in the mix. We're trying to diffuse the situation the best way we know how. God be with us. Go to places. (Actor stands as if he/she were a reporter.)

Actor

Is it true there are nuclear bombs all over the world?

Clown 2

No comment. Get out of here. Get out.

Actor

You heard. Get out.

(Lights out. Lights up on Dennis who is in moon lighting.)

Dennis

Trans-lunar injection burn. The moon is a different thing to each one of us my own impression is that it's a vast, lonely, forbidding type existence. What I keep imagining is it... I'm a lonely traveler, another planet would I think about the earth from this altitude whether I think it would be inhabited or not. You're going about six thousand feet a second. This transmission is coming to you proximately halfway between the moon and be earth. What I keep imagining is if I'm a lonely traveler from another planet would I land on the blue or the brown heart of the earth. You could never know how big this thing gets when there ain't nobody in here but one guy. This is not for real your back in the simulator just remember that. (Lights out. Lights up on stage and in the house.)

Clown 1

Now the last time we did this I shot you I really didn't think it over. It seemed the only option... Shut up. God damn it. Do I have to kill you again? I'll do it. I'll do it. Dead, dead, dead. Options... I push you out the door with a toy gun. Having you fend for yourself. (Mockingly.) It's not me. It's not me. If nothing looks like it's going to happen. I'll shoot you. Change in the plan. I'll start shooting immediately. Where at that time, time I'll get the gas can. Drone around stage absently pouring the gas can around the room. Maybe try to hold back tears. Lift the gas can over my head. Splash,

splash, splash, splash and say the first monologue. Come on. Fire. Explosions. I can hear the make believe phones ringing everywhere. Now, now, now don't you want to see what's behind wall number four. Hey I'm giving you a real chance. Number four. You kill me. Sorry, I give you the gun. You kill me. Guess who I'm cheering for. Yeah, sure, I know, I wouldn't pretend that I'm dead as long as others. Let's go cliché clown. Shhhhhhhh... (Clown flips the coin and snaps his hand over hand. Clown peeks to see the coin.) Clown 1, hostages 0, or vice versa. Yes, yes, yes, yes, I'm the winner. I'm the winner. Thank you playwright. I'm the winner. You are the loser. 1, 0000, 11, 000, 1, 00, 111111...

Hostage

NO. That wasn't vice versa. It wasn't vice versa. Why.

Clown 1

My arm is getting tired...

Hostage

Oh, my God.

Clown 1

You have said fuckin enough.

Hostage

Would you stop swearing? Please. Please. Please. I don't want to die.

Clown 1

Why did you stay for this in the first place? You know that my tears may actually be real when I do my thing. Actually I think that my life is now. I can really live. The set can leave. (The lights go out.) Start dreaming.

Police/Audience member

Fire. Fire. Oh my God, fire. Are you ready homeless man. Like I don't know where you are. (Sounds of struggling in the dark.) Oh you want the gun.

Dennis

Give it to me... (Clown 1 laughs.) You piece of shit. (Ten seconds of silence. The sound of splashing.) Turn on the light. (A light is provided. Dennis stands in the center of stage with the gas can over his head. He pours and begins wiping his face.) I am not here. I am not talking. I am not talking to you. I am not looking at you. You are not with me. I don't know where I am but this is not me this is someone else. This space. This actor. None of this is happening to me. I am not in this. You can't see me. I could be dead for all I know and not to waste any time this actor could be anybody. Maybe your daughter. Maybe your son. So what does this body look like? What color is their skin? Who's attracted to you? Who are you attracted to? Is this body short, tall? Do you like yourself? (Blows the match out. The clown 1 is provided with moon lighting. Clown 1 dances with a clown costume on visible strings. The light board operator determines the timing of the last cue to darkness.)

The show is over.